



Module 6: Creating Engaging Content

By the end of this module, you'll know how to create social media content that captures attention and drives real action — from stopping the scroll to generating leads, saves, shares, and sales.

THRM SOCIAL MEDIA TRAINING

What Makes Content Engaging?

Engaging content makes people want to *do something*. That action isn't always a like — it could be a save, a share, a DM, or a purchase. The goal is to create content that delivers value and prompts a response.



Stop Scrolling

Your content must earn attention in the first instant — before anything else.



Save

Saves signal deep value — the audience found it useful enough to return to later.



Like, Comment, Share

Traditional engagement signals that boost your content's reach and visibility.



Purchase or Enquire

The ultimate goal for business content — turning attention into revenue.

📌 A simple formula: **Attention → Interest → Value → Action**. Get attention, give a reason to continue, provide something useful, then guide toward action.

What Is a Hook — and Why Does It Matter?

A hook is the opening moment of your content. It determines whether the audience keeps watching, reading, or scrolls away. For a Reel, it's the first few seconds. For a carousel, it's the first slide. For a caption, it's the very first line.

✗ Weak Hook

"Today we're going to talk about Instagram marketing."

There is nothing here that gives the audience a reason to continue. It's generic, predictable, and safe — which means forgettable.

✓ Stronger Hook

"Your Instagram isn't growing because you're making these 3 mistakes."

Now the audience has a personal reason to keep watching. It's specific, problem-based, and creates immediate curiosity.



Types of Hooks You Can Use

There's no single formula for a great hook. Choose the type that best fits your content and audience.

1

Problem-Based

"Getting views but no enquiries?" — Speaks directly to a pain point your audience already feels.

2

Curiosity

"Nobody tells you this when you start social media marketing." — Creates a knowledge gap that compels people to fill it.

3

Benefit

"Here's how to create 30 days of content in one afternoon." — Leads with a clear, desirable outcome.

4

Contrarian

"You don't need to post every day to grow on Instagram." — Challenges a common assumption and earns attention.

5

Direct Audience

"If you're a café owner, save this." — Speaks to a specific person, making them feel the content was made for them.



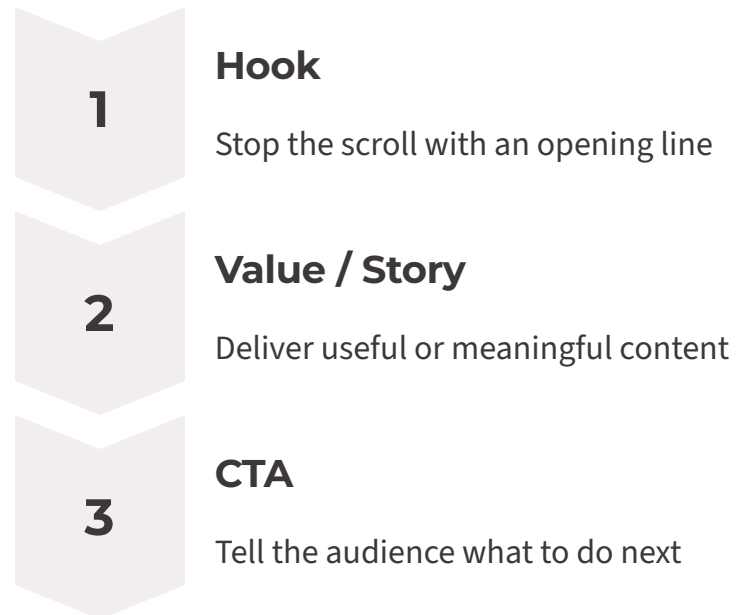
Important rule: Never clickbait. If your hook promises "5 ways to improve your Instagram bio," your content must actually deliver those five tips.

Captions and CTAs: The Written Engine of Your Content

What Is a Caption?

A caption is the written text that accompanies your post. It can explain, educate, tell a story, build a relationship, or guide the audience toward action. Caption length should match the content's purpose — not every post needs a long caption.

Basic Caption Structure



What Is a CTA?

A Call to Action tells your audience exactly what you want them to do next. Without one, people consume your content and simply move on. Match the CTA to the purpose of the post:

- **Educational post:** "Save this for later."
- **Relatable Reel:** "Tag someone who does this."
- **Product post:** "Shop now."
- **Lead content:** "DM us 'AUDIT' to get started."
- **Community post:** "Tell us your experience below."

Avoid repeating the same CTA on every post — it becomes invisible when overused.



Visuals and Visual Hierarchy

On social media, visuals communicate before the caption is even read. Strong visuals stop the scroll and signal professionalism, clarity, and brand consistency.

Be Clear

The viewer should understand the message at a glance, without effort or confusion.

Be Relevant

Every visual element should support the message — not distract from it.

Be Consistent

Fonts, colors, and style should align with your brand across all content.

Use Hierarchy

Guide the viewer's eye: primary message first, supporting detail second, CTA third.

For video content, a smartphone with good lighting, clear audio, and a strong idea is enough to create compelling, high-performing content. Equipment matters far less than clarity of message.

Storytelling: Making Your Brand Human

Storytelling transforms information into something people care about. It creates emotional connection — which is what makes content memorable and shareable.

Without Storytelling

"Our café has opened."

Factual. Forgettable. No emotional reason to engage.

With Storytelling

"We spent six months building a café we always wanted to visit ourselves.
Today, the doors are finally open."

Now the audience has a reason to care — and a reason to show up.

Types of Brand Stories

- **Founder Story**

Why did the business start? What was the original vision or struggle?

- **Customer Story**

How did the product or service help a real person?

- **Transformation Story**

What changed before and after using the product or service?

- **Behind-the-Scenes**

What happens behind the brand that the audience never sees?

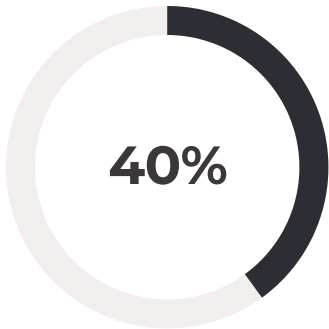
📌 Storytelling doesn't require a long video. Even a 15-second Reel can have a beginning, problem, and resolution — that's a complete story.

Trending vs. Evergreen Content

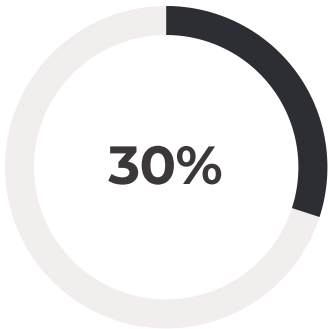
A strong content strategy uses both. Trending content generates timely visibility; evergreen content delivers lasting value. Use them together — not as a choice between one or the other.

 Trending Content • Uses popular audio, formats, challenges, or cultural moments • Can generate quick visibility and discovery • Participates in existing conversations • Becomes outdated quickly — act fast	 Evergreen Content • Remains useful weeks or months after posting • Performs well in search and saves • Educates and builds long-term authority • Examples: "How to write an Instagram bio," "Beginner's guide to skincare"
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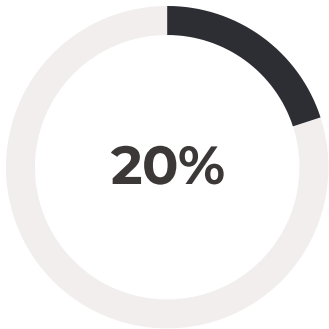
A practical starting point for content mix:



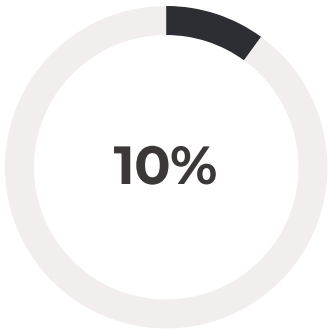
Evergreen Educational
Timeless tips, how-tos, and guides



Relatable / Entertaining
Builds connection and personality



Trending
Timely formats and cultural moments



Promotional
Products, offers, and services

8 Common Content Mistakes to Avoid

Even well-intentioned content can underperform. These are the most frequent mistakes that reduce engagement — and how to fix them.

1. Weak Hook

Starting with "Hi guys, today we're going to talk about..." loses the audience immediately. Start with the problem or the value instead.

2. Too Much Information

Cramming 10 points into one post overwhelms the audience. Break it into a carousel, a series, or multiple Reels.

3. No Clear Message

If the audience finishes watching and still doesn't know the point, the content needs a clearer core idea. Ask: "What is the one thing I want them to remember?"

4. Too Much Text on Visuals

Large text blocks in graphics push people to scroll. Use short sentences, clear headings, and visual hierarchy instead.

5. Weak or Missing CTA

Don't end with "Thanks for watching." Tell the audience exactly what to do next — save, comment, DM, or visit.

6. Copying Viral Content

A Reel that went viral for another brand worked because of their audience, timing, and personality. Use it as inspiration — not a template.

7. Chasing Every Trend

If you use every trend, your brand loses its identity. Trends should support your strategy, not replace it.

8. Focusing Only on Likes

Likes are one metric. Also track saves, shares, comments, profile visits, website clicks, leads, and sales. A post with few likes can still generate real business results.

The Content Creation Framework: 6 Questions Before You Post

Before creating any piece of content, answer these six questions. They give your content direction, purpose, and a higher chance of performing well.

1

WHO?

Who am I creating this for? Know your specific audience before anything else.

2

WHY?

Why am I creating it? Awareness, education, leads, or sales?

3

HOOK?

How will I earn their attention in the first second?

4

VALUE?

What will the audience get from watching or reading?

5

CTA?

What should they do next — save, comment, DM, or buy?

6

FORMAT?

Should this be a Reel, carousel, static post, or Story?



THRM Beginner Tip: Before you create content, don't ask "What should I post?" Ask: "**Why would someone stop scrolling for this?**"